

Getting Started & Your First Week

A step-by-step guide to setting up the addon, making your first profitable crafts, and building a daily routine that turns into steady gold.

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What GAM does, and what you need

Gold Advisor Midnight (GAM) compares the cost of crafting Midnight commodities with what they sell for on the Auction House. It then helps you buy the materials, craft, post, and see what really made gold.

GAM ships with **285 commodity strategies** across nine professions. A *strategy* is one way to make gold: a recipe, its materials, and the item you sell. Equipment, profession tools, bags, toys, mounts and bind-on-pickup crafts are left out on purpose, because they don't sell as interchangeable stacks.

The loop GAM is built around

STAGE	WHAT YOU DO	WHERE IN GAM
Scan	Read current Auction House prices for materials and crafted items.	Scan prices
Choose	Compare profit, return and break-even across strategies.	Strategy list, Details
Queue	Save a strategy with a craft count.	Add to Queue
Shop	Buy the combined materials for everything you queued.	Shopping , Quick Buy
Craft	Craft with one button, batch by batch.	Craft Queue
Post	List at the lowest price, never undercutting, and repost undercut auctions.	Posting
Learn	See your real profit and what to craft more or less of.	History

What you need

- **World of Warcraft Retail (Midnight)**, with at least one character that has a crafting profession.
- **Access to an Auction House.** Prices come from scanning it live, so most of the work happens there.
- **Some starting gold.** 5,000–20,000g is plenty for the small test batches in week one. GAM keeps a reserve so you never spend everything.

Optional addons that GAM works with

ADDON	WHAT IT ADDS
TradeSkillMaster	A Sale rate column in the strategy list, and a sensible starting quantity on the Posting tab (about one auction's worth of sales). It's optional, but helps you avoid crafting things that don't sell.
Auctionator	GAM can create an Auctionator shopping list from your missing materials (Tools > Shopping).
CraftSim	GAM can send its prices and craft plans to CraftSim (Tools > CraftSim).

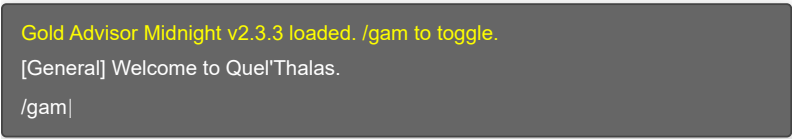
How GAM prices things, in one paragraph

Materials are priced from the listings you would actually have to buy for the full quantity. Cheap "bait" listings are ignored, and missing stock is priced at the highest listed price. Crafted items are valued at the lowest listing, because at equal prices the newest listing sells first. When GAM is unsure, it assumes higher costs, so its estimates are on the cautious side.

Installing the addon

This takes a couple of minutes.

- 1 **Download** the latest release from the GitHub releases page (link at the end of this guide) and unzip it.
- 2 **Copy the GoldAdvisorMidnight folder** into `World of Warcraft\_retail_\Interface\AddOns\`
If an older version is there, replace it. Your settings are stored separately and are kept.
- 3 **Check the folder name.** The path must end in `AddOns\GoldAdvisorMidnight\GoldAdvisorMidnight.toc`. A common mistake is ending up with `GoldAdvisorMidnight\GoldAdvisorMidnight\` (a folder inside a folder). The addon won't load if that happens.
- 4 **Start the game.** On the character select screen, click `AddOns` and make sure **Gold Advisor Midnight** is ticked. If you are already in game, type `/reload`.
- 5 **Look for the welcome line** in chat: `Gold Advisor Midnight v2.3.x loaded. /gam to toggle.`



Gold Advisor Midnight v2.3.3 loaded. /gam to toggle.
[General] Welcome to Quel'Thalas.
/gam|

Figure 2.1 When GAM loads it prints this line in chat. Type `/gam` to open the main window.

Opening GAM

WAY TO OPEN	WHAT IT DOES
<code>/gam</code> or <code>/goldadvisor</code>	Opens or closes the main window.
Minimap button	Left-click opens or closes the window, right-click opens Settings, and you can drag it around the minimap. You can turn it off in Settings > General.
<code>/gam settings</code>	Opens the Settings window.
At the Auction House	A Gold Advisor button appears beside the Auction House window. You can also set GAM to reopen there if you left it open last time.

A tour of the main window

Everything you need is in one window. The top bar picks *what* to look at, the list shows every strategy, and the pane on the right holds the work tabs.

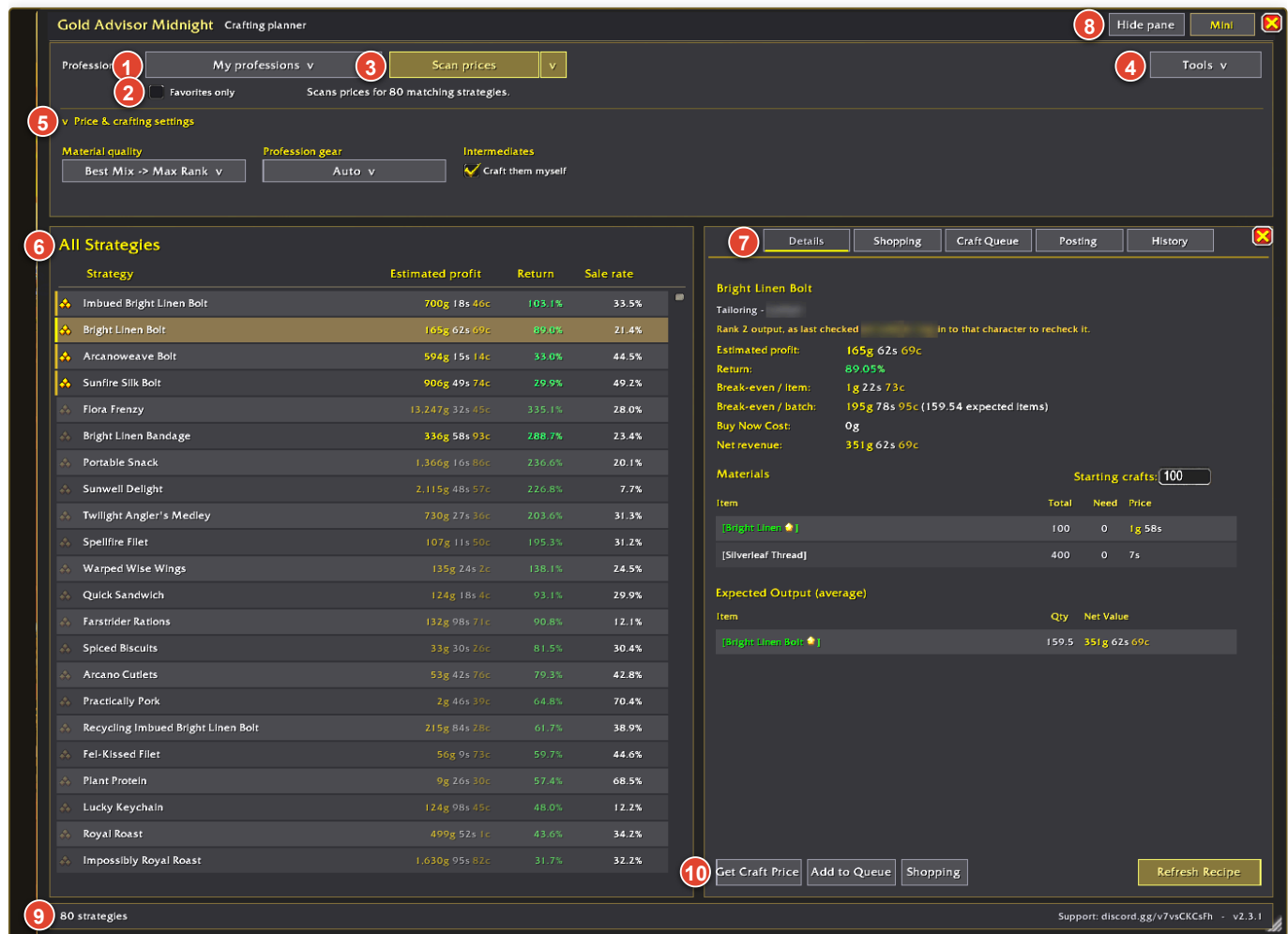


Figure 3.1 The main window in its full layout, after a scan. A strategy is selected and the Details tab is open.

- 1 Professions** picks which strategies to show: *My professions*, *All professions*, or any combination.
- 2 Favorites only** narrows the list to strategies you starred.
- 3 Scan prices**, and its **v** arrow for other scan choices. The line underneath says how many strategies a scan covers.
- 4 Tools:** Shopping (Auctionator list), Quick Buy, Cooldowns, CraftSim and Export.
- 5 Price & crafting settings**, shown expanded: Material quality, Profession gear and Intermediates.
- 6 Strategy list.** Click a column header to sort, and click the icon on the left to favorite.
- 7 Work tabs:** Details, Shopping, Craft Queue, Posting and History.
- 8 Hide pane** and **Mini**. Mini switches to one small tabbed window, and **Full** brings this layout back.
- 9 Status bar** with the strategy count, scan progress, the Discord link and your version.
- 10 Detail actions:** Get Craft Price, Add to Queue, Shopping and Refresh Recipe.

The work tabs

TAB	USE IT TO...
Details	Read the selected strategy's profit, break-even, materials and expected output, then click Add to Queue .
Shopping	See every material your queued plans still need, combined, minus what you own. Select a material and buy it.
Craft Queue	Craft your plans step by step with the big button at the bottom.
Posting	Post what you crafted, and cancel and repost auctions that were undercut.
History	See what you spent, sold and really earned, with suggestions on what to craft next.

In **Mini** mode there is one more tab, **Strats**, which holds the strategy list.

First-time setup

Do this once on **each character who crafts**. It takes about 20 minutes, and it is the difference between rough estimates and estimates for *your* character.

Why setup matters

GAM's numbers depend on your crafter's Multicraft and Resourcefulness, specialization bonuses, gear, and the output rank your skill can reach. Until it has seen these, GAM uses conservative default stats and rank 1 output. That is safe, but often understates what you can make.

Step 1 — Show your professions

Open GAM with `/gam`. Click the **Professions** dropdown and choose **My professions**. The list now shows only the strategies this character can craft. To browse what an alt could make, choose **All professions** or tick individual professions, then click **Done**.

Step 2 — Open each profession once

Open your profession window (default key **K**) and wait a couple of seconds. GAM quietly reads the stats of every strategy recipe this character knows, your specialization bonuses, and the output rank this character reaches. You don't need to click each recipe. When you change gear or spend knowledge points, opening the profession again reads the new stats.

Salvage recipes (milling, prospecting, crushing, recycling, shatter) only show their stats with an item selected. Open one with an item in the slot, or select the strategy in GAM and click **Refresh Recipe** in Details.

Once a profession has been opened, strategies this character can't craft are **dimmed** in the list. Hover one to see why, and which of your characters has learned it.

Crafting on an alt? Open GAM there once.

Log into each crafter, open GAM, and open their professions. After that, every one of your characters prices those recipes with that crafter's real rank and materials. Details shows a line such as "*Rank 2 output, as last checked on [your crafter].*" You can shop on your main and craft on your alt.

Step 3 — Choose Material quality

Click **> Price & crafting settings** to expand the settings row, then open **Material quality**.

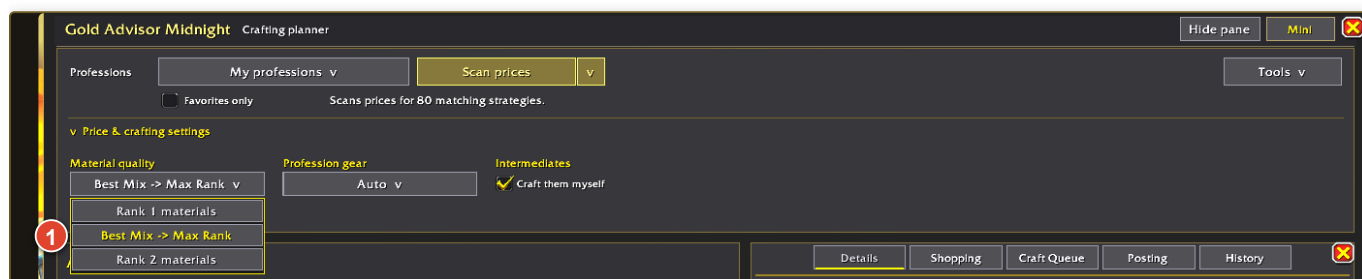


Figure 4.1 The expanded settings row with the Material quality menu open 1. When the row is collapsed, the summary on the right shows your current choices, for example *Materials: Best mix | Gear: Auto*.

OPTION	WHEN TO USE IT
Rank 1 materials	The default. Cheapest materials and lower-rank output. A safe starting point.
Best Mix -> Max Rank	GAM finds the cheapest verified mix of rank 1 and rank 2 materials that still reaches the best output rank your crafter can make. This is the most profitable choice for most players once recipes are captured.
Rank 2 materials	Uses rank 2 materials everywhere. Only worth it if your skill turns them into higher-rank output.

GAM never assumes Concentration. If rank 2 materials can't reach rank 2 output for your crafter, GAM tells you, including how much skill you still need.

Step 4 — Save your profession gear sets (optional, recommended)

If you own separate **Multicraft** and **Resourcefulness** profession gear, save each set once so GAM can price with the right stats.

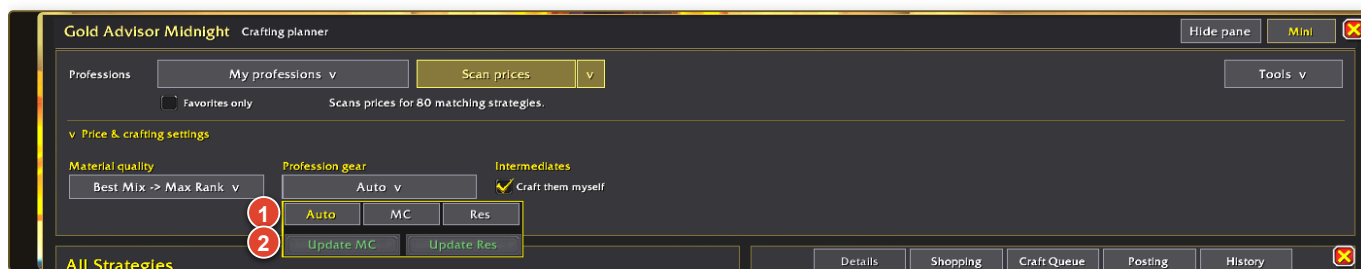


Figure 4.2 The Profession gear menu. **1** chooses how this strategy is priced: **Auto**, **MC** (Multicraft) or **Res** (Resourcefulness). **2** saves the gear you are wearing as that set. The buttons read **Save MC** / **Save Res** until a set is saved, and **Update MC** / **Update Res** after that.

- 1 Equip your Multicraft gear and open any recipe of that profession.
- 2 Open the **Profession gear** menu and click **Save MC**.
- 3 Equip your Resourcefulness gear and click **Save Res**.
- 4 Leave the choice on **Auto**. GAM then prices each strategy with whichever saved set earns more.

Sets fill in their own stats. Whenever the profession window is open and you're wearing a saved set, GAM keeps that set's exact stats for every strategy recipe. Wear each set once with the profession open after saving it, and again after spending knowledge points. Sets saved with an older version of GAM don't need saving again: just wear them once with the profession open. On **Auto**, GAM usually picks Multicraft for recipes that have Multicraft and Resourcefulness for the ones that don't, such as salvage, enchants and gear.

The save buttons turn **green** when you are wearing that set and **orange** when it is saved but you're wearing different gear. Hover one to see the saved items. Sets are saved per profession and per character, and every strategy of that profession shares them. The Craft Queue shows which set each step uses, and it can put the right set back on with **Equip saved profession set**.

Enchanters: Shattered Essence

GAM won't save stats or a gear set while Shattered Essence is active, because its bonus lasts only minutes. Save and refresh when it has worn off.

Step 5 — Decide on Intermediates

Some strategies use materials you could craft yourself, such as bolts you weave from cloth or pigments you mill from herbs. Tick **Intermediates: Craft them myself** and GAM compares buying each one with crafting it, then uses whichever is cheaper. Materials you'll craft are marked **(crafted)** in Details, and the Craft Queue lists each step in order.

For week one, leave it **off**. Learn the simple buy-craft-sell loop first, then try it on day 5.

Step 6 — Check the Settings that matter

Open `/gam settings` (or right-click the minimap button). Most defaults are sensible. These are the ones worth a look on day one:



Figure 4.3 Settings > Pricing. 1 the page list, 2 Default starting crafts (50 out of the box, set to 100 here), 3 Gold reserve, 4 manual material prices. Press **Apply & Close** when you're done.

SETTING (PAGE)	DEFAULT	RECOMMENDATION FOR WEEK ONE
Default starting crafts Pricing	50	How many crafts each strategy is priced for. 50–100 works well for comparing strategies. You'll set a smaller count on each strategy before queueing it.
Gold reserve (%) Pricing	20%	Shopping warns you and suggests craft counts that fit if buying would leave less than this share of your gold. Raise it to 30–40% while you learn.
Allow manual material prices Pricing	Off	Turn on if you gather your own herbs or ore and want to price them yourself. Right-click a material in Details to set a price, and it shows an amber dot. Sale prices always come from the Auction House.
Auction duration Posting	12 hours	Use 24h or 48h if you only log in once a day. Longer auctions cost a bigger deposit, and you lose the deposit if the auction expires.
Starting quantity Posting	About one auction's worth (TSM)	Keep this setting. Without TSM data it posts everything in your bags.
Low-profit warning Posting	—	A yellow dot shows when a price is barely above break-even. Many gold makers stop posting under 20% over break-even.
Minimum profit per craft Posting › Crafting history	0 (off)	Set it to something like 5–10g, so GAM points out strategies below it and History stops suggesting them. Nothing is ever blocked.
Keep history for Posting › Crafting history	—	90 days is a good balance. History is what tells GAM what really sells for you.

Setup checklist

- ☐ GAM loads and `/gam` opens the window
- ☐ Professions set to **My professions**
- ☐ Each profession opened once on its crafter (salvage recipes with an item selected, or captured with **Refresh Recipe**)
- ☐ Material quality chosen (Best Mix once recipes are captured)
- ☐ Multicraft and Resourcefulness gear sets saved and each worn once with the profession open, with Profession gear on **Auto**
- ☐ Gold reserve and Auction duration checked in Settings

Your first price scan

Prices come only from the Auction House, so every session starts there.

- 1 **Go to an Auction House** and open it. Keep GAM open beside it.
- 2 **Click** **Scan prices**. GAM reads every material and crafted item for the strategies in your current list. The line below the button says how many strategies that is.
- 3 **Wait for the progress bar** at the bottom to finish. While scanning, the button reads **Stop scan**, and you can click it to stop early. Closing the Auction House also stops the scan.
- 4 **Sort the list by Estimated profit or Return** by clicking the column header.

Gold Advisor Midnight Crafting planner

Professions: My professions v **1** Stop scan v

Scanning prices: 1 / 4 Items. Click Stop scan to cancel.

> Price & crafting settings Materials: Best mix | Gear: Auto

All Strategies

Strategy	Estimated profit	Return	Sale rate
Imbued Bright Linen Bolt	700g 18s 46c	103.1%	33.5%
Bright Linen Bolt	165g 62s 69c	89.0%	21.4%
Arcanoweave Bolt	594g 15s 14c	33.0%	44.5%
Sunfire Silk Bolt	900g 49s 74c	29.9%	49.2%
Flora Frenzy	13,247g 32s 45c	335.1%	28.0%
Bright Linen Bandage	336g 58s 93c	288.7%	23.4%
Portable Snack	1,366g 16s 86c	236.6%	20.1%
Sunwell Delight	2,115g 48s 57c	226.8%	7.7%
Twilight Angler's Medley	730g 27s 36c	203.6%	31.3%
Spellfire Filet	107g 11s 50c	195.3%	31.2%
Warped Wise Wings	135g 24s 2c	138.1%	24.5%
Quick Sandwich	124g 18s 4c	93.1%	29.9%
Farstrider Rations	132g 98s 71c	90.8%	12.1%
Spiced Biscuits	33g 30s 26c	81.5%	30.4%
Arcano Cutlets	53g 42s 76c	79.3%	42.8%
Practically Pork	2g 40s 39c	64.8%	70.4%
Recycling Imbued Bright Linen Bolt	215g 84s 28c	61.7%	38.9%
Fel-Kissed Filet	56g 9s 73c	59.7%	44.6%
Plant Protein	9g 26s 30c	57.4%	68.5%
Lucky Keychain	124g 98s 45c	48.0%	12.2%
Royal Roast	499g 52s 1c	43.6%	34.2%
Impossibly Royal Roast	1,630g 95s 82c	31.7%	32.2%
Void-Kissed Fish Rolls	54g 43s 95c	30.7%	38.5%
Laced Zoomshots	1,285g 92s	27.3%	17.5%
Bright Linen Spellthread	25g 84s 20c	23.1%	25.5%

80 strategies **3** 1 / 4 scanning... Stop scan Support: discord.gg/v7vsCKCsPh - v2.3.1

Bright Linen Bolt

Tailoring -

Rank 2 output, as last checked In to that character to recheck it.

Estimated profit: 165g 62s 69c
 Return: 89.05%
 Break-even / Item: 1g 22s 73c
 Break-even / batch: 195g 78s 95c (159.54 expected Items)
 Buy Now Cost: 0g
 Net revenue: 351g 62s 69c

Materials Starting crafts: 100

Item	Total	Need	Price
[Bright Linen Bolt]	100	0	1g 58s
[Silverleaf Thread]	400	0	7s

Expected Output (average)

Item	Qty	Net Value
[Bright Linen Bolt]	159.5	351g 62s 69c

Stop scan Add to Queue Shopping Refresh Recipe

Figure 5.1 A scan in progress. **1** the button now reads **Stop scan**, **2** the line below it counts items, and **3** the progress bar fills in the status bar.

Scan choices

CHOICE (V ARROW)	SHORTCUT	SCANS...
Current list	Click	The strategies matching your filters.
All professions	Ctrl-click	Every supported strategy, regardless of filters.
Favorites	Alt-click	All your favorites, regardless of profession filters.
Selected strategy	Shift-click	Only the selected strategy and its materials.

Reading the list after a scan

YOU SEE	IT MEANS
Estimated profit	Expected profit for the starting craft count, with return as a percentage. Negative numbers mean you'd lose gold at today's prices.
! Missing prices	A material or output wasn't found. Scan again, or the item may not be listed on your realm right now.
Sale rate (TSM)	How often the item sells across your region. A higher number means it sells faster. A dash means TSM has no data. This is a guide, not a guarantee.

Favorite the strategies you like

Click the icon to the left of a strategy name. Favorites move to the top with a gold marker. With **Favorites only** ticked, or with Alt-click on Scan prices, your daily scan covers just the strategies you actually craft, and takes a fraction of the time.

A very high return is a reason to look closer

A return of 200% or more often means a thin market: few listings, or an output that rarely sells. Check the Sale rate and the listings before you put real gold behind it.

Each scan saves a small price summary per item, so your numbers still make sense after a `/reload`. Prices go stale, though. Scan again at the start of every session.

Reading a strategy

Click any strategy to open it in **Details**. This is where you decide whether it's worth crafting.



Figure 6.1 Details for Imbued Bright Linen Bolt, with Intermediates on.

- 1 **Output rank** and the character it was checked on.
- 2 **Estimated profit** and **Return** for this batch.
- 3 **Break-even** per item and per batch: the lowest sell price that covers your materials after the 5% AH cut.
- 4 **Buy Now Cost**: gold needed up front. **Net revenue**: expected sales after the cut.
- 5 **Starting crafts**: the batch size for this strategy only.
- 6 **Materials**: Total needed, what you still Need to buy, and the Price. (*crafted*) means you'll make it yourself.
- 7 **Expected output** on average, including Multicraft.
- 8 **Add to Queue** saves the plan to the Craft Queue. **Shopping** opens its shopping list.
- 9 **Refresh Recipe** recaptures stats from the crafter.

Estimates are averages

Multicraft and Resourcefulness are random. Over 100 crafts the results land close to the estimate. Over 5 crafts they can land well above or below it. That's normal, and it's one reason week one uses small batches.

The numbers that matter

LABEL	WHAT IT TELLS YOU
Estimated profit	Net revenue minus the expected material cost. Materials you already own are counted at market price, because crafting has to beat simply selling them.
Return	Profit as a percentage of cost.
Break-even / item	The lowest price you can post at without losing gold. The Posting tab uses it to warn you.
Buy Now Cost	Gold you need up front for what you still have to buy. It ignores bonus procs, so make sure you can afford this number. It's 0g when you already own everything.
Net revenue	Expected sale income after the 5% Auction House cut.

The craft loop: queue, shop, craft, post

You will repeat this loop every day. Learn it once with a small batch and it becomes second nature.

A. Queue

In **Details**, set **Starting crafts** (for your first try, about 5), then click **Add to Queue**. The plan keeps its craft count, material ranks and intermediate choices. Later scans won't change a plan you have already queued. Add more strategies and their shopping is combined.

B. Shop

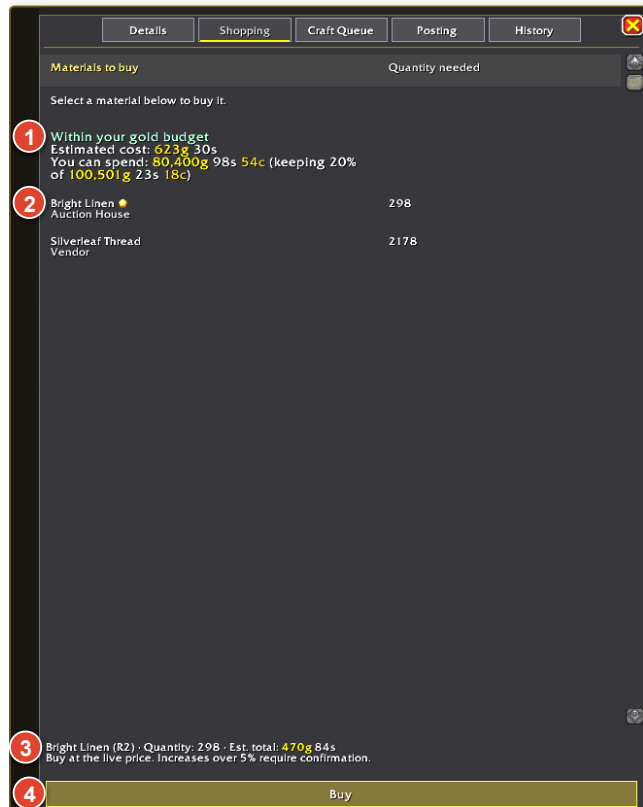


Figure 7.1 The Shopping tab.

- 1 Gold check.** Compares the cost with your gold, keeping your reserve.
- 2 Materials to buy,** combined for every queued plan, minus what's in your bags, bank, reagent bank and Warband bank. The second line says where to buy it.
- 3 The selected material,** with quantity and estimated total.
- 4 Buy:** GAM gets a live quote first. A price rise of more than 5% needs your confirmation.

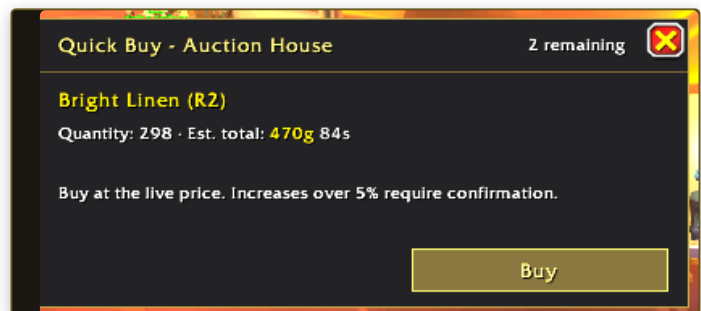


Figure 7.2 The Quick Buy panel appears beside the Auction House, or beside a vendor, when your queue needs something sold there. It's the fastest way to work through the list.

- Nothing is bought without your click.
- If buying everything would break your gold reserve, Shopping offers **Reduce crafts** to lower the counts to what fits.
- Auction House purchases arrive by **mail**. Shopping counts them as bought straight away, but you can only craft with items you have collected from the mailbox.
- Vendor materials, like Silverleaf Thread, are bought at the vendor. Quick Buy opens there too.

C. Craft

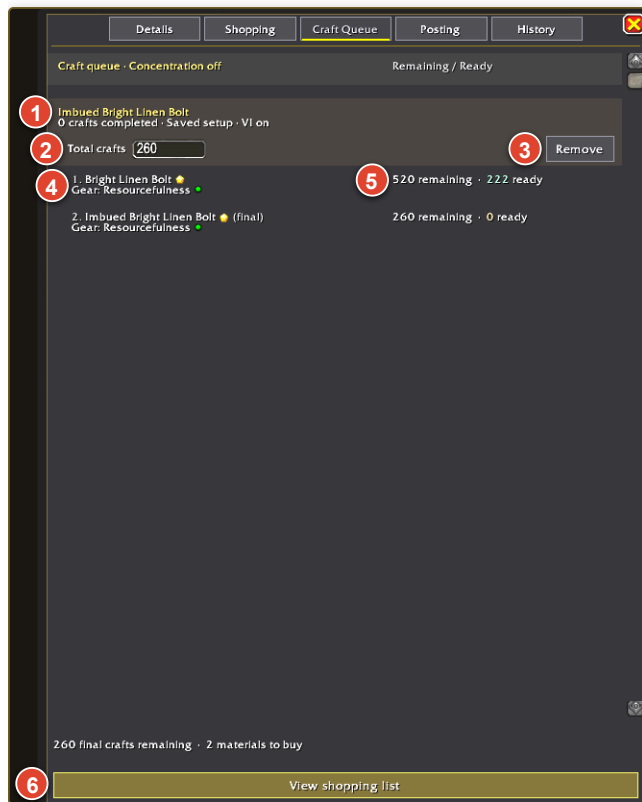


Figure 7.3 The Craft Queue with one plan. Intermediates are on (VI on).

- 1** The **plan**: crafts completed, saved setup, and whether intermediates are on.
- 2** **Total crafts**. Change it and press Enter. Escape cancels.
- 3** **Remove** deletes the plan and releases its materials.
- 4** Each **step** in order, with the gear set it uses. The green dot means you're wearing it.
- 5** **Remaining / ready**: how many crafts are left, and how many you have materials for right now.
- 6** The **next-action button**. It always shows what to do next: *View shopping list*, *Collect materials from mailbox*, *Open recipe*, or *Craft next*.

- Press the next-action button. Each new recipe needs one click, and **Stop** (or closing the main window) stops after the current craft.
- Before each batch, GAM checks your recipe, equipped gear, material ranks, output rank and cooldowns. If anything changed, it asks you to review instead of crafting the wrong thing.
- Craft counts are **recipe casts**, not items made. Multicraft bonus items come on top.
- If you **/reload** in the middle of a batch, GAM asks you to confirm how many crafts were completed.

D. Post



Figure 7.4 The Posting tab at the Auction House.

- GAM never undercuts. At an equal price the newest listing sells first, so matching the lowest price is enough.
- Rows start **unticked** when the price is below break-even, the item keeps expiring, you already have enough listed, or the only listings look far above the item's usual price. Hover the dot to see why. You can still tick them.
- Blizzard requires a click for each auction, so the button walks through your ticked rows one at a time (1 of 3).
- Auctions that were undercut are ticked in **On the Auction House**, and the same button cancels and reposts them. GAM only ticks a cancel when reposting stays above break-even and the lost deposit is small.
- Items in your bank must be taken out first, because GAM only posts from bags.

Your first week, day by day

The plan: start small, learn what sells on *your* realm, and let History tell you where to put your gold. Each day takes 20–40 minutes.

DAY	FOCUS	YOU'LL END THE DAY WITH...
Day 1	Setup and first test batch	Two small plans crafted and posted.
Day 2	Check in, collect, repost	Your first sales, and two more strategies being tested.
Day 3	Reading History	A clear idea of which tests are working.
Day 4	Scale up the winners	Your first bigger batch (20–50 crafts).
Day 5	Intermediates and stats	Your own intermediates where they're cheaper, and refreshed stats.
Day 6	Tuning posting	Fewer expired auctions and lost deposits.
Day 7	Weekly review	A favorites list and a daily routine you trust.

Day 1 Setup and your first test batch

~45 min (includes setup)

Goal: complete the whole loop once, with gold you don't mind risking.

1. Finish the **first-time setup** in Chapter 4 on your main crafter.
2. At the Auction House, click **Scan prices** with **My professions** selected.
3. Sort by **Estimated profit**. Pick **two** strategies with a solid profit, a reasonable **Return** (15%+ is a good start) and, if you have TSM, a decent **Sale rate**.
4. For each one: open **Details**, set **Starting crafts** to **5**, and click **Add to Queue**. Favorite both strategies.
5. Open **Shopping** and buy everything (or use the Quick Buy panel). Collect your purchases from the mailbox.
6. Open **Craft Queue** and press the next-action button until both plans are done.
7. Go back to the Auction House, open **Posting**, and post your crafts.

Why only 5 crafts?

A test batch shows you whether the item really sells at that price on your realm, for very little risk. The players GAM was tested with tried two new strategies every other day this way, and only scaled up the ones that sold.

Day 2 Check in, collect, repost

~25 min

Goal: learn the "coming back" half of the routine.

1. **Collect your mail.** Sales, expired auctions and cancelled items all come back by mail. GAM reminds you in chat when auction mail is close to running out.
2. Open the Auction House with GAM open and click **Recheck** on the Posting tab to re-read your auctions and current prices.
3. In **Posting > On the Auction House**, look at what is ticked to cancel and repost. Press the button to work through them, then post anything that came back.
4. **Scan prices**, then test **two more** strategies at 5 crafts each, as on day 1.

Day 3 Reading History

~30 min

Goal: turn your sales into decisions.

1. Do your check-in (collect, recheck, repost), as on day 2. If something unexpected happens, Chapter 10 lists the common cases.
2. Open **History** (Figure 8.1). The totals at the top show what you spent, what you sold after the cut, deposits lost, your **realized profit**, and gold still sitting in unsold stock.
3. Read the **suggestions** and the **Verdict** column. Verdicts appear once an item has 10 or more posted.
4. Click **Show batches** to follow each test batch from purchase to sale, using the materials it really used at what you paid. The same button then switches to **Show log** (every event) and back to the suggestions.

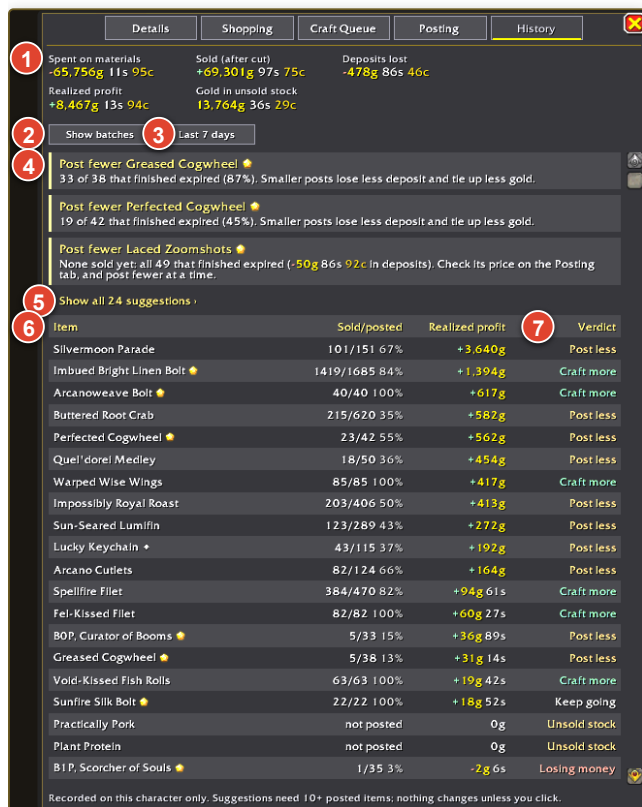


Figure 8.1 History after a few weeks of crafting.

- 1 **Totals:** spent on materials, sold after the cut, deposits lost, realized profit, and gold in unsold stock.
- 2 **Show batches**, which cycles to Show log and Show suggestions.
- 3 The **period**: last 7 days up to all of your kept history.
- 4 **Suggestions**, ranked by gold. A *Craft more* suggestion has a **Queue N crafts** button.
- 5 **Show all** suggestions.
- 6 **By item:** sold/posted with sell-through, and realized profit.
- 7 **Verdict:** Craft more, Keep going, Post less, Unsold stock or Losing money.

Day 4 Scale up the winners

~40 min

Goal: put more gold behind what is proven to sell.

1. Check in as usual, then **Scan prices**. Alt-click scans just your favorites.
2. In **History** (after that scan, so it uses today's prices), look for **Craft more**. Its **Queue N crafts** button adds about a week of *your own* sales, minus what you already own, have listed or have queued, within 80% of your gold.
3. Or scale up by hand: open the strategy in Details and queue 20–50 crafts.
4. Keep testing: add one or two new strategies at 5 crafts.
5. Shop, craft and post. With more items to post, watch the **Qty** column. Posting about one auction's worth at a time loses less deposit when the market moves.

Day 5 Intermediates and fresher stats

~30 min

Goal: squeeze more margin out of the strategies you already like.

1. Expand **Price & crafting settings** and tick **Intermediates: Craft them myself**. Strategies whose materials you can make more cheaply (bolts, inks, ingots) will show higher profit, and their materials show (*crafted*) in Details.
2. Queue one of them and open **Craft Queue**. It lists each step in order (Figure 7.3), for example the Bright Linen Bolts before the Imbued Bright Linen Bolts.
3. If you spent knowledge points or changed gear this week, open each profession once in each saved set so GAM reads the new stats. If you replaced gear, click **Update MC / Update Res** first.
4. Switch **Material quality** to **Best Mix -> Max Rank** if you haven't yet, and compare.

Plans keep their setup

A queued plan keeps the settings it was added with. If you change settings, re-add the strategy, or use

Use current setup on the plan when GAM asks.

Day 6 Tune your posting

~25 min

Goal: fewer expired auctions and lost deposits.

1. In **History**, check **Deposits lost** and any item marked **Post less**. Its suggestion says how many expired.
2. If your auctions often expire before you're back, GAM shows a hint on the Posting tab. Raise **Auction duration** in Settings > Posting to match how often you log in.
3. Set a **Low-profit warning** (for example 20%) and a **Minimum profit per craft** so marginal items stand out.
4. For items that sell slowly, post smaller quantities more often.

Day 7 Weekly review

~30 min

Goal: lock in a routine you can repeat every week.

1. Open **History** for the last 7 days. Compare **Realized profit** with **Gold in unsold stock**. If a lot of gold is sitting in stock, slow down crafting and post what you have.
2. **Unfavorite** strategies marked **Losing money**. Keep and scale **Craft more**.
3. Clear finished plans in the Craft Queue (**Clear**). Their results stay in History.
4. Log into each alt crafter once so cooldowns and recipe ranks are current. **Tools > Cooldowns** tracks daily and weekly crafts across all your characters.
5. Write down your routine. If you play every day, several times a day, or on several characters or accounts, Chapter 9 has a routine for each. The checklist in Chapter 11 is a good starting point.

For active players

Once your first week is done, how you use GAM depends on how much you play. This chapter covers four common setups: on every day, on several times a day, several characters, and more than one WoW account.

First: what is shared, and what isn't

This decides almost everything below. GAM saves its data once per **WoW account**, and keeps some of it separately for each **character**.

Shared by every character on the account

- Settings and favorites
- Scanned prices: a scan on one character prices strategies for all of them
- Recipe captures and each crafter's output rank
- Manual material prices (if you keep them)
- The Cooldowns tracker, which lists every character
- Login reminders, which cover every character's expired auctions and expiring mail

Kept separately for each character

- The Craft Queue
- History, sales rates and suggestions
- Profession gear sets
- Posting: what's in this character's bags and bank, and their auctions and mail
- The gold check in Shopping, which uses this character's gold only

The Warband bank is your friend

Shopping and the Craft Queue count materials in the Warband bank as owned, and the game crafts straight from it. Putting materials there is the quickest way to hand them to another crafter on the same account. No mail, no waiting.

On every day

One session a day, 30–45 minutes. This is the routine GAM was tested with.

- 1 **Read the login reminders** in chat. They name any character whose auctions expired or whose Auction House mail is about to run out.
- 2 **Collect mail**, then open the Auction House with GAM open. Your auctions are read automatically; press **Recheck** for fresh Posting prices.
- 3 **Cancel and repost** what's ticked under **On the Auction House**, then post anything that came back.
- 4 **Scan your favorites** (Alt-click Scan prices).
- 5 **History**: follow the *Craft more* suggestions with **Queue N crafts**, and add one or two small tests.
- 6 **Shop, craft, post.**

Set **Auction duration** to **24 hours** (Settings > Posting) so auctions are still up when you're back tomorrow. With 12-hour auctions you'll lose deposits overnight, and GAM shows a hint on the Posting tab if that keeps happening.

On several times a day

Short check-ins between one main session. More visits mean you can keep auctions short, react to undercuts and post smaller amounts more often.

SESSION	WHAT TO DO
Main session once a day, ~30 min	The full daily routine above: scan, History, queue, shop, craft, post.
Check-in 5–10 min	Collect mail. Open the Auction House with a GAM window open so your auctions are checked. Repost what's ticked, post what came back, and top up anything that sold out. No scan needed unless you queue something new.

- **Auction duration:** 12 hours suits you, with a smaller deposit at risk if it expires.
- **Don't chase every undercut.** Each cancel loses the deposit. GAM only ticks a cancel when the lost deposit is small, and won't re-tick the same item for an hour after you repost it. Trust that, rather than ticking everything yourself.
- **Post smaller amounts.** Keep Posting's starting quantity on *About one auction's worth*. You'll be back before it sells out.
- **Prices move during the day.** If your last scan is a few hours old, scan your favorites before queueing. Shopping always checks the live price before buying, so stale prices can't make you overpay.
- **Expired items wait in the mail.** Collect them on each check-in so they show up on the Posting tab again.

Prices are checked when you ask

Press **Recheck** on the Posting tab (or a Scan button) to re-read your auctions and prices. To have GAM check on its own when the Auction House opens and after each post or cancel, turn on **Check prices automatically** in Settings › Posting. It only runs while a GAM window is open.

Several characters on one account

Many players spread professions across alts. GAM handles this well if you know where it keeps each thing.

- 1 **Open GAM once on every crafter** and open their recipes. After that, every character prices those recipes with the right crafter's rank, so you can scan and compare from any character.
- 2 **Save gear sets on each crafter.** They're per character.
- 3 **Buy, craft and post on the same character when you can.** History follows each batch from purchase to sale, and records only what happened on that character. If you buy on one character and sell on another, the seller's History won't know what you paid. It shows profit as unknown, and Posting falls back to the strategy's estimated break-even.
- 4 **Move materials through the Warband bank** rather than the mail. It counts as owned straight away for whoever crafts.
- 5 **Move gold before shopping.** The gold check only sees the gold of the character you're on. Put enough gold on the buyer first, through the Warband bank, or GAM will suggest fewer crafts than you can afford.
- 6 **Use Tools › Cooldowns** for daily and weekly crafts. It lists every character, and offline characters keep counting down. Log into one to confirm a reset.
- 7 **Read the login reminders.** They tell you which character has expired auctions or mail about to run out, so nothing is lost on an alt you rarely visit.

A simple setup that works

Pick one **seller** character who lives near the Auction House. Craft on each crafter, then send the finished goods to the seller. Keep each crafter's Craft Queue on that crafter. Look at **History on each crafter** to judge what's profitable, and use the seller's Posting tab to sell. Posting finds strategy outputs on the seller under *Other items GAM strategies make*.

More than one WoW account

GAM's data lives in your account's own folder:

```
World of Warcraft\_retail\_WTF\Account\<ACCOUNT>\SavedVariables\GoldAdvisorMidnightDB.lua
```

Each WoW account has its own folder, so **nothing is shared between accounts**: not settings, favorites, prices, recipe captures, gear sets, the queue or History.

- **Set up each account separately.** Do the Chapter 4 setup on each one: professions, recipes, Material quality, gear sets and Settings.
- **Scan on each account.** Prices from one account's scan aren't seen by the other.
- **Don't copy the file from one account to another.** It replaces that account's Craft Queue, History and gear sets. It's fine to keep a copy as a **backup**, but copy it only while the game is closed.
- **Move goods and gold between accounts by mail or trade.** The Warband bank belongs to one account. Items arriving by mail count once collected. History on the receiving account won't know their cost, the same as a sale on another character.
- **Running two game windows at once?** Each has its own GAM. If one shows "AH throttled, retrying...", let one finish its scan before starting the other, or raise **Scan Delay** in Settings > General.
- **Give each account a job.** For example, one account for Alchemy and Inscription and the other for Tailoring and Enchanting. Fewer professions per account means shorter scans and a cleaner History.

Crafting at scale

SITUATION	ADVICE
Batches of 100+ crafts	Estimates become reliable at this size, since Multicraft and Resourcefulness average out. Set Default starting crafts to match, so the list compares strategies at the size you really craft.
The market can't supply it	GAM sizes History's suggestions to what your last scan showed. In Shopping, a material marked "Only N listed" means you're buying out the market. Lower the plan rather than paying the highest listings.
Flooding your own market	Watch Post less verdicts and Gold in unsold stock in History. Several strategies at medium size beat one strategy at huge size.
Many plans in the queue	Shopping combines them all and counts what you own once. If gold is short, Reduce crafts lowers them together. Clear finished plans so the queue stays readable. Their results stay in History.
Thin profit at scale	Set Minimum profit per craft (Settings › Posting) so low-margin strategies are flagged and History stops suggesting them.
Long-term records	Keep history for 180 days or a year (Settings › Posting › Crafting history). Older events are kept as totals.
After spending knowledge points or upgrading gear	Open each profession once in each saved set (Update MC / Update Res first if you replaced gear). Queued plans then ask you to use the current setup.

When things don't go to plan

The unusual situations new players run into, grouped by where they happen. For each one: what you'll see, why it happens, and what to do. Most of them are GAM protecting your gold, not something broken.

One rule covers most of them

GAM never buys, crafts, posts or cancels anything without your click, and it never guesses. When something doesn't match what it expects (prices, gear, ranks, materials), it stops and asks. Read the message, fix the one thing it names, and carry on.

Installing and opening

YOU SEE	WHY	WHAT TO DO
<code>/gam</code> does nothing, no "loaded" line	The addon is disabled, or the folder is nested twice.	Enable it on the character screen. Check that the path ends in <code>AddOns\GoldAdvisorMidnight\GoldAdvisorMidnight</code> . Then <code>/reload</code> .
"...failed while building the UI."	Usually another addon interfering, or a broken update.	Reinstall GAM (replace the whole folder), <code>/reload</code> , and report it with a Support summary (see the end of this chapter).
The window is too big or small	Your game UI scale.	Settings > General > UI Scale , or use Mini for one small window.
Text isn't in your language	The interface is English-only for now.	Translations will return after review by native speakers.

Professions and characters

YOU SEE	WHY	WHAT TO DO
"No supported professions detected."	This character has no supported crafting profession. Gathering professions alone aren't strategies.	Choose professions in the dropdown to browse anyway. Gatherers can still see which crafts use their herbs, ore and cloth.
A profession you have isn't listed	GAM covers nine Midnight crafting professions, and commodities only. Gear, tools, bags, toys, mounts and bind-on-pickup crafts are left out on purpose.	Craft those in Blizzard's profession window as usual.
Profit is lower on an alt than on your crafter	The alt doesn't know the recipe, so GAM prices it with rank 1 output.	Log into the real crafter once with GAM open and open that profession. All characters then use that crafter's rank.
Strategies are dimmed in the list	This character hasn't learned the recipe, or doesn't have the profession.	Hover the strategy to see which, and which of your characters has learned it. Craft it there, or learn it.
"Rank N output, as last checked on [crafter]. Log in to that character to recheck it."	The rank was saved on another character and may be out of date.	Normal. Log into that crafter after you gain skill or spend knowledge points.

"Rank 2 materials only produce rank 1 without Concentration. Needs N more skill..."	Your skill can't turn rank 2 materials into rank 2 output yet.	Use Rank 1 or Best Mix . GAM never plans to use Concentration.
"Rank 2 output not verified."	GAM hasn't seen the recipe on this crafter.	Open that profession on this crafter, or click Refresh Recipe .
"This recipe is not in this character's recipe list."	You clicked Refresh Recipe on a character who hasn't learned it.	Learn it, or log into the crafter who knows it.
"(fallback stats)" next to the gear	No gear set is saved for that profession and mode.	Save MC / Save Res (Chapter 4, step 4). Until then GAM uses conservative default stats.
Gear save button is orange	You're wearing different profession gear than the saved set.	Equip the set, or click the button to replace the set with what you're wearing.
"...were upgraded or re-enchanted since the set was saved."	The saved gear changed.	Save the set again with Update MC / Update Res .

Scanning

YOU SEE	WHY	WHAT TO DO
"Open the Auction House first."	Scans need the Auction House window open.	Open it, then scan.
"AH closed — scan stopped."	You closed the Auction House, or walked away, mid-scan.	Reopen it and scan again. Prices already read are kept.
"AH throttled, retrying..."	Blizzard limits how fast addons can query the Auction House.	Wait; GAM retries by itself. If it keeps happening, raise Scan Delay in Settings > General.
"! Missing prices" on a strategy	Nothing was listed for a material or the output when you scanned.	Scan again later. If an item is never listed on your realm, that strategy can't be priced there.
Scanning takes a long time	Ctrl-click scans every strategy in every profession.	Scan only your professions, or your favorites (Alt-click).
Item names show as "???" or "Item data unavailable"	The game hasn't loaded that item's data yet.	Visit the Auction House, scan, and it fills in.
Numbers look old after a break	Prices are only as fresh as your last scan.	Scan at the start of every session.

Reading the numbers

YOU SEE	WHY	WHAT TO DO
A huge return (200%+)	Often a thin market: very few listings, or an output that rarely sells. The lowest listing may be one lucky auction.	Check the Sale rate and the listings. Test with 5 crafts before trusting it.
Profit is positive but Buy Now Cost is high	Buy Now Cost is the gold needed up front, without counting bonus procs.	Make sure you can afford Buy Now Cost, not just the profit.

Buy Now Cost is 0g	You already own every material.	Normal. Profit still counts your materials at market price, because selling them is the alternative.
Your 5-craft test made much more or much less than estimated	Multicraft and Resourcefulness are random. Estimates are averages over many crafts.	Judge a strategy on History over several batches, not on one small batch.
A crushing or salvage strategy looks odd	Crushing is priced as sell-only, and strategies that use Glimmering Gemdust buy it rather than plan to crush ore.	Expected; it keeps estimates conservative.
Your own gathered herbs are priced at market	GAM values materials at what you could sell them for.	To use your own price, turn on Allow manual material prices (Settings > Pricing) and right-click the material. It lasts until logout unless you also tick Keep manual prices after logout .

Queueing

YOU SEE	WHY	WHAT TO DO
"...needs native crafting controls and cannot be queued."	A few recipes can't be crafted by an addon, such as recrafting existing equipment.	Craft them in Blizzard's profession window.
"Profit per craft ... is below your minimum"	Your Minimum profit per craft setting.	Just a note; you can still queue it.
"Your last N batches of this lost ... after costs"	History shows it lost gold before.	Think twice, or test again with a small batch.
"You already have N ... about N days of your sales."	You own or have listed plenty already.	Sell what you have first.
Changed a setting, but the queued plan didn't change	Queued plans keep the setup they were added with, on purpose.	Use Use current setup on the plan, or remove it and add it again.
Clicked Add to Queue twice	Each click queues another batch.	Lower Total crafts or Remove the extra plan.
Queue N crafts in History uses old numbers	N comes from your own sales history, but whether it's shown, the gold cap, and how much the market can supply come from your last scan.	Scan the strategy first (Shift-click or Alt-click Scan prices), then click it. Shopping still checks live prices before buying.
"Queued 30 of 46 crafts: your last scan showed materials for 30."	The Auction House didn't list enough materials for the full count.	Fine as is, or scan again later and add more.

Buying materials

YOU SEE	WHY	WHAT TO DO
"Not enough gold for these materials"	Buying everything would break your gold reserve (20% by default).	Click Reduce crafts , or sell first. Change the reserve in Settings > Pricing.
A material shows a warning dot: "Only N listed..."	The market lists fewer than you need.	Buy what's there and lower the plan, or wait. The rest may cost more or not exist yet.

"Not enough ... on the Auction House: stopped buying..."	Quick Buy ran out of one material, so it stops buying that plan's others so they don't sit unused.	Use Lower to N , or scan later and press Retry .
Asked to confirm a price	The live price is more than 5% above your scan.	Accept, or skip and buy later.
"The quote expired."	You waited too long to confirm.	Click Buy again for a new quote.
"No confirmation ... Check your mailbox before buying it again."	The Auction House didn't confirm in time. The purchase may have gone through.	Check your mail before buying again, so you don't buy twice.
"The Auction House is cheaper. Buy this material there."	A fresh AH price beats the vendor.	Buy it at the Auction House instead.
"Vendor purchase was not fully received."	Your bags are full.	Free bag space and try again.
Bought it, but can't craft	Auction House purchases arrive by mail. Shopping counts them, but crafting needs them in your bags.	Collect your mail. If you collected it across a /reload, press Collected in Shopping.

Crafting

YOU SEE	WHY	WHAT TO DO
"Open your profession first." / "Open recipe: ..."	The recipe isn't open.	Press the button. It opens the recipe for you.
"Leave combat before crafting."	Crafting and posting don't work in combat.	Leave combat.
"Equip the saved ... set on ..., then retry."	The plan was priced with gear you aren't wearing.	Press Equip saved profession set . If items are in the bank, take them out. If it says to free a bag slot, do that.
"Live recipe stats differ from this estimate."	A buff, gear or spec change altered your stats.	Put the gear or buff back, or press Use current setup .
Review output rank	The output rank you'd get now differs from the plan.	Review it. Accept ranks updates the plan and keeps your progress.
"Only N of these N crafts are ready now (cooldown)"	The recipe has charges or a cooldown.	Craft what's ready. The rest waits for charges. Track them in Tools > Cooldowns.
Reloaded or disconnected mid-batch	GAM can't be sure how many crafts finished.	Enter the real total completed count and press Confirm .
"Crafted outside GAM."	You crafted the same thing in Blizzard's window.	Confirm the total completed crafts for the plan before continuing.
"Recipe materials changed or a required reagent is missing."	The recipe changed, for example after a patch.	Refresh Recipe , then remove the plan and add it again.

Salvage (crushing, recycling) or enchanting jobs	Salvage keeps its exact input item and rank. Enchants need one vellum per craft, which is added to Shopping.	Keep the right input in your bags.
"N additional crafts from unreserved materials..."	Resourcefulness left you spare materials.	Optional: Queue N more uses only what you have and never buys more.

Posting

YOU SEE	WHY	WHAT TO DO
A row starts unticked	Below break-even, expired often, already listed, or the only listings look far above the usual price.	Hover the dot to see which. You can still tick it.
" +N bank" next to an item	GAM only posts from bags.	Take the items out of the bank first.
Items you crafted before GAM, or bought, show up under "Other items"	They're strategy outputs found in your bags or bank, so they start unticked in case they're your materials.	Tick only what you want to sell, or turn the list off in Settings > Posting.
"Blizzard warns this price is unusual."	The game thinks the price is far from normal.	Check it, then press the button again to confirm.
"Small listing at the top" warning	Only a few units sit at the lowest price.	The tooltip shows the next price. Type it if you'd rather match that.
"Room to sell higher" on your auction	You're the cheapest by a margin, and the next seller is well above you.	It's only ticked when the extra gold beats the lost and new deposits.
"Posted after you" on your auction	Someone matched your price later, and the newest listing sells first.	Repost if it's ticked. GAM won't re-tick the same item for an hour, so you don't lose a deposit every few minutes.
"Leave it" on your auction	Reposting at the new lowest price would be below break-even.	Let it sell or expire. Expired items come back by mail.
"You need ... to cancel it."	Cancelling costs the deposit, and you don't have the gold.	Sell something first, or leave it.
"Your auctions often expire before you're back."	Your auction duration is shorter than the time between visits.	Raise Auction duration in Settings > Posting.
"Auction House mail runs out in N days"	Sales gold and returned items wait in the mailbox, but not forever.	Collect your mail on that character.

History

YOU SEE	WHY	WHAT TO DO
"Nothing recorded yet."	History starts when GAM is installed, and is per character.	Craft and post a few times. Log into each seller to see theirs.
"Not enough data" / no suggestions	Verdicts and suggestions need 10+ posted items in the period.	Keep going, or choose a longer period.

Profit not shown for an item	GAM has no recorded purchases for it, so your cost is unknown.	Buy through Shopping next time so History knows your cost.
"Cost is estimated from the break-even..."	That batch was crafted before GAM counted the materials used.	Normal for older batches.
Sales on another character are missing	Each character records its own purchases, crafts, posts and sales.	Open GAM on the character that posted.
Want a fresh start	Old test batches skew the numbers.	Settings › Posting › Clear history . This can't be undone.

Other addons

YOU SEE	WHY	WHAT TO DO
No Sale rate column numbers	TradeSkillMaster isn't installed, or it has no data for that item.	Optional. Without TSM, Posting also defaults to everything in your bags.
"Auctionator not installed."	Tools › Shopping makes an Auctionator list.	Install Auctionator, or just use GAM's own Shopping tab.
CraftSim prices changed	Pushing to CraftSim replaces manual prices there.	Only push if you're happy for GAM's prices to be used.
Sales or crafts made with other addons	GAM still records them.	Nothing to do. If you craft a queued item elsewhere, confirm the count in the Craft Queue.

When you need help

- 1 Type `/gam log` and open the **Troubleshooting** page.
- 2 Run **Support summary**, then reproduce the problem.
- 3 Click **Copy All** and paste the text in Discord with a short description.

Two maintenance tools live there too: **Price cache** clears saved prices (scan again afterwards), and **Strategy data** reloads the strategy list without a `/reload`.

Daily checklist, commands and glossary

Every session

- ☐ Collect mail (sales, returns, purchases)
- ☐ Open the Auction House with GAM open
- ☐ Posting › On the Auction House: cancel and repost what's ticked
- ☐ Post anything that came back
- ☐ Scan prices (Alt-click for favorites)
- ☐ Queue: suggestions, plus 1–2 small tests
- ☐ Shopping / Quick Buy, then collect the mail
- ☐ Craft Queue: press the next-action button
- ☐ Posting: post your new crafts

Every week

- ☐ History review: Craft more / Post less / Losing money
- ☐ Prune favorites
- ☐ Open each profession in each saved set after spending knowledge points
- ☐ Update MC / Res after gear changes
- ☐ Log into alts once (cooldowns, ranks)
- ☐ Clear finished Craft Queue plans

Golden rules

Keep a gold reserve. Never post below break-even unless you choose to. Test before you scale. Trust History over estimates.

Commands

COMMAND	WHAT IT DOES
<code>/gam</code> , <code>/goldadvisor</code>	Open or close the main window
<code>/gam settings</code>	Open Settings
<code>/gam log</code>	Open the Debug Log and Troubleshooting checks
<code>/gam globalstartqty 50</code>	Set the default starting crafts for all strategies
<code>/gam help</code>	List all commands

Glossary

Strategy	One recipe-to-sale way of making gold that GAM can price.
Break-even	The lowest sell price that covers your material cost after the 5% AH cut.
Multicraft (MC)	A chance to craft extra items. It raises your expected output.
Resourcefulness (Res)	A chance to get some materials back. It lowers your expected cost.
Intermediates / VI	Crafting your own materials (vertical integration) instead of buying them.
Sell-through	The share of the items you posted that actually sold.
Realized profit	What you really earned: sales after the cut, minus what you paid, minus lost deposits.

Help and updates

Release history: github.com/crystaltech/GoldAdvisorMidnight/releases

Discord: discord.gg/v7vsCKCsFh